WEIGHT 02

Tirzepatide

Synthetic peptide that switches on two gut-hormone receptors, GIP and GLP-1; binds albumin to last longer



CLASS Peptide

STUDIED FOR Weight, diabetes, sleep apnea

HUMAN EVIDENCE Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS FDA approved (Zepbound, Mounjaro)

STUDIED FOR

- **Body weight** — HUMAN
- **Blood sugar** — HUMAN
- **Sleep apnea** — HUMAN
- **Heart outcomes** — HUMAN

Mounjaro for weight is off-label. In the US, Mounjaro is approved for type 2 diabetes and heart risk; Zepbound for weight and sleep apnea.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Tirzepatide ▶ GIP/GLP-1 receptor ▶ Appetite areas ▶ Lower food intake

- **Binds and activates** both the GIP and GLP-1 receptors (label)
- **GLP-1** is a regulator of appetite and calorie intake
- **GIP** may add to food-intake control, per nonclinical studies
- **Brain appetite areas** reached and activated in animal studies

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Phase 3 trials: SURPASS, SURMOUNT, SURMOUNT-OSA
- SURMOUNT-1: 2,539 adults, 72 weeks
- Heart trial vs dulaglutide: 13,299 adults

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Thyroid C-cell tumors in people

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
About 5 to 6 days (Zepbound label)

ROUTES STUDIED
Injection under the skin, once weekly

PHARMACOKINETICS
Peak in about 24 hours (8 to 72); broken down by protein cleavage

SOLD AS
Prescription injection (Zepbound, Mounjaro)

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Weight, HbA1c, sleep apnea index; kidney function per label

SPORT (WADA)
Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved: Mounjaro 2022, Zepbound 2023
FDA	Compounded versions not FDA approved
EMA	Authorised (Mounjaro, 2022)
WADA	Not prohibited; 2027 Monitoring Program

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Zepbound prescribing information, Sep 2026
2. Jastreboff et al., SURMOUNT-1, N Engl J Med, Jul 2022
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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